



Red Wash after-action review: what the false starts changed

Document ID: SH-PS-AAR-001 | **Version:** 1.0.0

Event/effective date: 2026-09-05 | **Available to case company:** 2026-09-05

Created at: 2026-09-05T22:16:52-07:00 | **Publication cutoff:** 2026-09-05T23:59:59-07:00

Fictional authors: Evan Vilander, Mari Varela and Martin Shaw, with retained operating dissent

Record origin: SYNTHETIC_COMPANY_ANALYSIS | **Evidence state:** SYNTHETIC_RECONSTRUCTED

Decision state: LOCKED_DERIVED_IMPLEMENTATION retrospective participant record

The July 18, 2025 acquisition did not prove every Red Wash assumption right. It established that Sable Harbor would accept a bounded set of known liabilities and uncertain operating outcomes at a price and with a rehabilitation plan it could fund. This review asks what changed in the process, not whether hindsight can turn the acquisition into an inevitable answer.

Earlier failure	Changed Red Wash practice	Surviving limitation
Cedar Junction: asset ownership mistaken for operating capability	Inspect ventilation, controls, maintenance, team continuity and customer consent before treating installed plant as productive capacity	Inspection and a retained team cannot guarantee future reliability
Juniper Mesa: cheap entry mistaken for a short path to revenue	Model representative feed, water/closure obligations and rehabilitation timing alongside purchase price	Future normalized throughput needs its own processing-day/capacity bridge
Salt Rim: a respected expert substituted for judgment	Reconcile Norwood, Sutter, Cole, geological evidence and operating records at claim level; preserve dissent	An integrated evidence base can still be wrong about physical conditions

Mari's 2024 "Nine Ways We Are Wrong" review remained controlling technical challenge. Smoothed East 12 boundaries, historic dilution/cutoff inconsistency and carbonate-rich feed response were not polished away. Tailings Cell 1 underdrain/MW-17 concerns, omitted closure scopes, fan/control redundancy, obsolete motor-control equipment, moisture/assay timing and contract/escalation/title defects remained in the acquired case. The deal's environmental escrow did not convert those matters into someone else's operating responsibility.

Martin separated a willingness to understand the mine from a willingness to buy it. When seller expectations outran the supported case, Sable Harbor walked away. The return to negotiations changed price/risk allocation and the funded operating plan. It did not make Norwood's original representations retrospectively correct. Henry Norwood and NMI remain the Red Wash seller; Fred Tolman belongs to the separate ARU transaction.

Cole's 2025 temporary halt demonstrated an authority distinction. An operator can act conservatively when observed conditions diverge from the model without claiming complete causal knowledge. Evidence and explanation follow; the halt's legitimacy does not depend on an eventual victory story. Mari protects that authority. Vilander must preserve it when a platform customer, capital proposal or internal technology demonstration creates pressure to keep moving.

The carrier-capacity problem after closing extended the same method. Qualified external carriers handled every 2025 Red Wash movement. The Q4 search broadened into "Whose line is this?" and surfaced ARU/BS&T. ARU's independent customer base, succession needs and capital cycle had to support its own acquisition case. Red Wash did not retroactively supply ARU's 2025 revenue or justify its \$62M enterprise value.

At this cutoff, direct ARU/BS&T uranium custody remains OPEN_GATED. Conventional inbound-material service and a timestamp-control incident do not close that gate. The intercompany rate must show cost, competitive comparison and asset ownership; a desired \$875,000 revenue or \$365,000 EBITDA result cannot determine the answer. Qualified outside carriers remain an enduring option.

Sources: [Red Wash transaction](#), [current Red Wash casebook](#), [Pale Sun appointment](#), [ARU diligence](#). This participant-visible AAR supplies management's interpretation and dissent, not a hidden scoring rubric or evaluator conclusion.